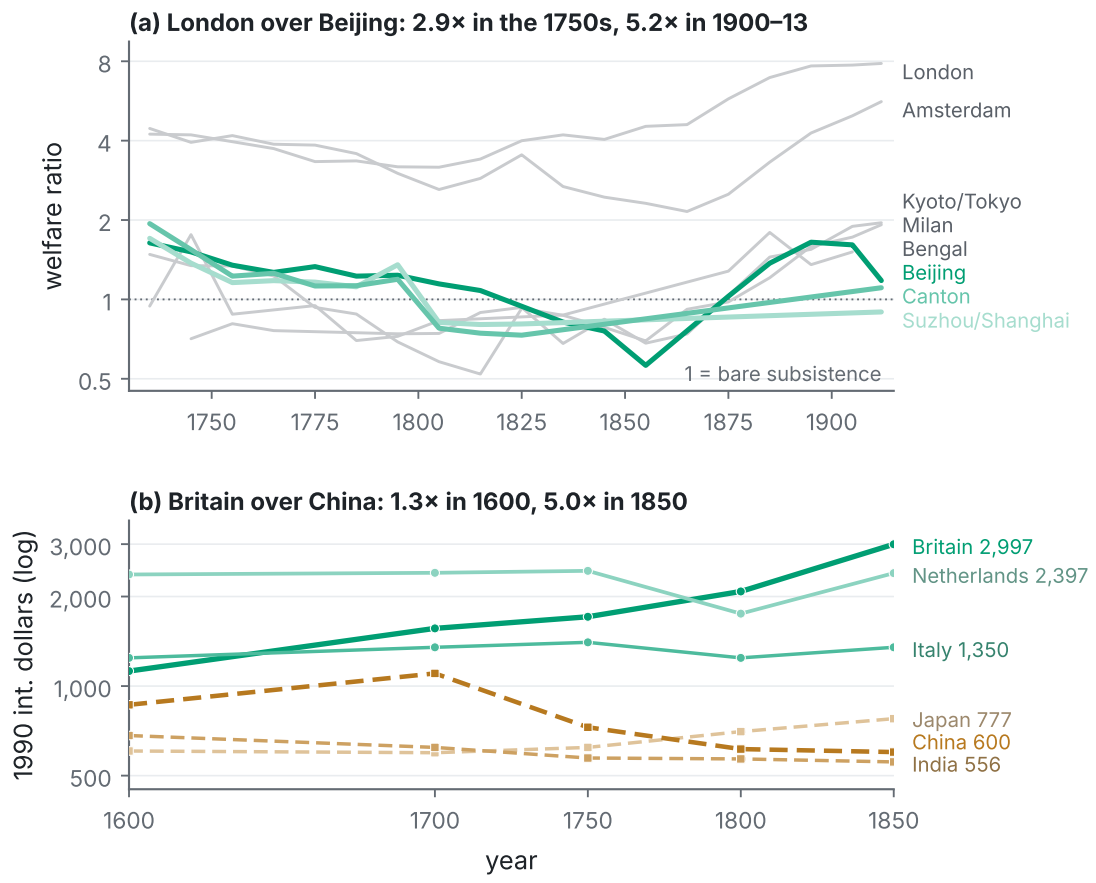
(a) London over Beijing: 2.9× in the 1750s, 5.2× in 1900–13
welfare ratio
8
4
2
1
0.5
1 = bare subsistence
1750
1775
1800
1825
1850
1875
1900
London
Amsterdam
Kyoto/Tokyo
Milan
Bengal
Beijing
Canton
Suzhou/Shanghai
(b) Britain over China: 1.3× in 1600, 5.0× in 1850
1990 int. dollars (log)
3,000
2,000
1,000
500
1600
1700
1750
1800
1850
year
Britain 2,997
Netherlands 2,397
Italy 1,350
Japan 777
China 600
India 556